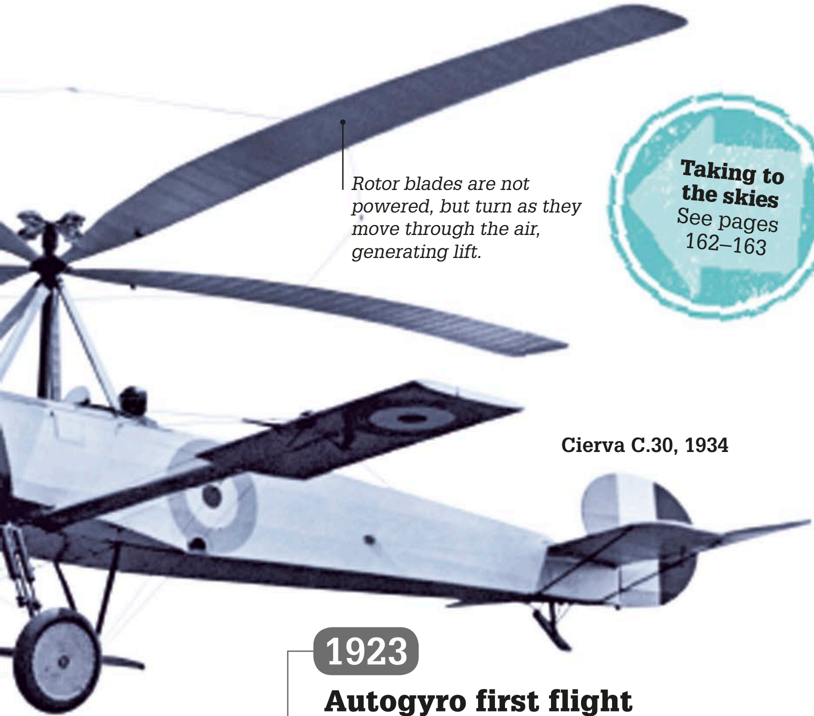


Cierva C.30, 1934

Taking to the skies
See pages 162–163

1923

Autogyro first flight

The Cierva C.4 autogyro made its first 590-ft- (180-m-) long flight from the Spanish city of Getafe. The craft—designed by Spanish engineer Juan de la Cierva—used long, thin, winglike rotor blades to provide lift, and helped pave the way for the helicopter.

1924

A new galaxy

American astronomer Edwin Hubble concluded that Andromeda was not a spiral nebula (a large cloud of dust and gas) in the Milky Way galaxy but an entire, separate galaxy. Hubble's discovery came after he measured distances to stars in Andromeda and found them farther away than the diameter of the Milky Way. We now know that Andromeda is around 2.54 million light years away and is 220,000 light years across.

The Andromeda Galaxy contains one trillion stars.

1925

1923

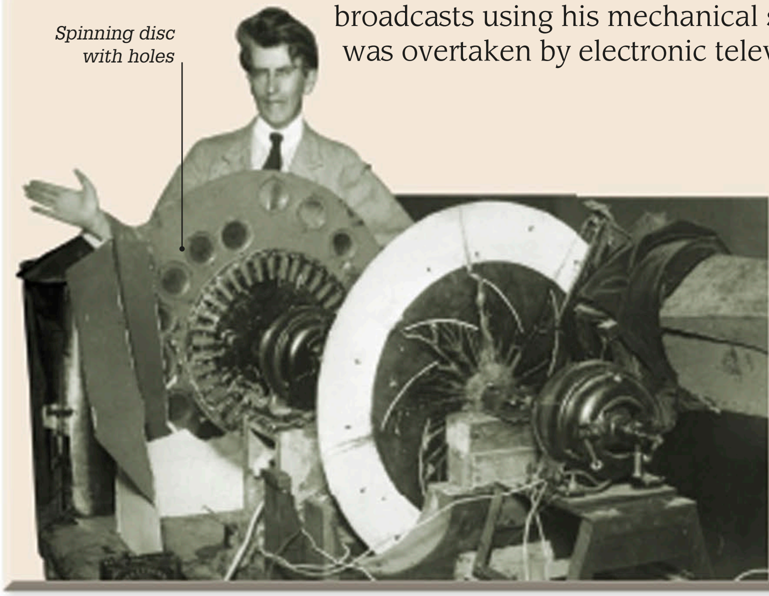
Dinosaur eggs

The first scientifically proven dinosaur eggs were discovered in Mongolia's Flaming Cliffs region. The expedition, led by American naturalist Roy Chapman Andrews, also discovered *Protoceratops* and *Velociraptor* dinosaur fossils for the first time. At first, the eggs were thought to be from *Protoceratops* but later studies revealed they were eggs of *Oviraptor*—small dinosaurs that lived some 75 million years ago.

Fossilized *Oviraptor* eggs

1888–1946 JOHN LOGIE BAIRD

Scottish inventor John Logie Baird devised shaving razors before constructing his first mechanical television (TV) in 1924 using household objects, such as sewing needles and a cookie tin. In 1928, he sent the first TV pictures under the Atlantic Ocean from the UK to the US and also devised a video recorder called Phonovision. The BBC began experimental broadcasts using his mechanical system, which was overtaken by electronic television in the 1930s.



Early television
Baird's mechanical television used a spinning disk full of tiny holes to scan an image. Flashes of light passing through the holes were turned into electrical signals and sent to a receiver. There, the signals were converted back into light and displayed on a screen via a second spinning disk.